ANKIT PRASAD

MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS | CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT | PRODUCTION & SUPPLY PLANNING

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SUMMARY

Manufacturing operations leader in a high-volume 24/7 food plant — ran 2nd shift for 200+ hourly employees across 5 production areas; now own 13-week production, material and capacity planning across 4 lines and 3 sites. Improved OEE 21%, cut downtime 25% and MTTR 18% via SCADA/MES/CMMS loss analysis; cut changeover 75% with an equipment redesign; added 40% packaging speed on existing equipment (~$470K/line/yr). Safety → Quality → Throughput leader who works from the floor and builds the data tooling behind the decisions. M.S. Engineering Management (Industrial & Systems focus), B.E. Civil Engineering.

SKILLS

Operations & methods: Plant & shift leadership (200+ hourly) • OEE & downtime analysis • Process & equipment improvement • SMED • RCA • Failure Analysis & Risk Assessment • SPC • Statistical sampling • Equipment reliability (MTTR, PM) • Shutdown & startup protocols • Standard work & SOPs • Production scheduling & capacity planning • Material planning • Supplier quality • Safety, GMP, HACCP, FDA/FSMA • ISO 9001/14001/22000

Systems & tools: Ignition SCADA • MES • CMMS • InfinityQS • ERP/MRP systems (Sage MAS, Scanco, Netstock) • Advanced Excel / Power Query • Office Scripts • Power BI • SQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Alamance Foods | Burlington, NC **03/2025 – Present**

Operations Planner — Aerosol Department, Multi-Site Planning *03/2026 – Present*

- Selected from plant operations to own the 13-week master production schedule and material planning across 4 lines and 3 sites — aligning forecast, orders, inventory and capacity to set build quantities, inventory targets and line loading; report to the Director of Operations.
- Release weekly schedules across all four lines — what runs, how much, where, when, in what sequence — balancing line eligibility, batch constraints, pack formats and changeovers to minimize setup loss.
- Own material readiness in Sage/MAS ERP, Scanco and Netstock — item-level inventory policies, replenishment parameters, ~$3M in weekly cream inventory and tanker timing — and drive shortage and recovery planning.
- Built the decision tooling behind the plan — cases-to-make logic, schedule-quality audits and plan-vs-actual reconciliation — as Excel/Office Scripts applications and dashboards now used for weekly planning.

Operations Manager — 2nd Shift, Production Operations *03/2025 – 03/2026*

- Ran 2nd shift for 200+ hourly employees across 5 production areas, directing the area Plant Managers on shift; owned safety, quality, staffing, attendance and schedule attainment, plus 1st-shift closeout and 3rd-shift startup for 24-hour continuity.
- Improved OEE 21%, cut MTTR 18% and reduced downtime 25% by mining Ignition SCADA, MES and CMMS data to isolate recurring loss modes — filler jams, palletizer faults, coder errors, piston misalignment — and driving corrective action to closure.
- Cut flavor changeovers from 40 to 10 minutes (75%) with a water-manifold redesign after finding the flush sequence, not the mechanical teardown, was the constraint; added 1 hour of attainment per shift (12.5%) with a 30-minute shift-overlap system.
- Designed a chute and pouch handling system that ran a new pack format on existing equipment (+40% packaging speed, ~$470K per line annually) instead of buying a new line; rebuilt rework workflows for $500K+ annual labor savings.
- Authored 15+ equipment-care and shutdown protocols and bilingual SOPs and Work Instructions covering blow-molding, CIP, sanitation, allergen control and traceability, putting safety-critical procedures in the workforce's primary language.
- Led a palletizer spec change across Engineering, Packaging, Graphics, Supply Chain and Warehouse, with customer approvals, enabling double-stacking in the warehouse.
- Owned the Gallon Line end to end (Operations, Quality, Maintenance, Supplier Quality) — ended recurring jug leaks with a Supplier Quality Verification Program using statistical sampling and shift-wise leak testing that isolated the defect to incoming material.
- Ran RCA on an out-of-spec batch after exhausting recovery options, took the loss rather than ship it, and implemented material tracking with Quality as a standing stakeholder to prevent recurrence.
- Fulfilled 100% of hurricane-season demand for 3 high-volume customers under constrained capacity, working the line alongside the crew through full runs of dual 2.5-gallon cases (~45 lbs).

Rebecca Everlene Trust | Business Analyst — Operations & Supply Chain (Volunteer) | Remote, IL **10/2024 – 03/2025**

- Coordinated a 5-person analysis team; used SQL to find budgeting and procurement inefficiencies that cut operating costs 9% on a $1.5M budget; built Power BI dashboards for utilization and vendor performance.

UNC Charlotte | Research & Data Analyst | Charlotte, NC **02/2023 – 08/2024**

- Led 8 research assistants directing a 4-stage, 145-participant study analyzing three simultaneous physiological sensor streams (RSP, ECG, fNIRS); published at AHFE 2025 and ACM ICMI 2025.

Trigyn Technologies | Supply Chain QA/QC, Quality Executive | Mumbai, India **09/2020 – 03/2022**

- Led ISO 14001 certification in 3 months; built an IoT-monitored vaccination cold-chain risk registry, improving compliance 32%.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

M.S. Engineering Management, UNC Charlotte, 2024 | **B.E. Civil Engineering, Mumbai Univ., 2019** | Scrum.org PSM I & PSPO I